

Scream 4?

The first in a series of Wearable Body Organs: the ScreamBody, a portable space for screaming. When you are about to experience the need to scream, inhale as much as possible and scream your lungs out. You can record the scream for later use to see how you fared!



Virus In The Neeson

About a hundred Japanese Zen Neeons, Creative's 5 GB MP3 player, were infected with the W32.Wullik.B@mm virus. After Creative caught this Outlook-spamming nasty, it recalled the majority of them. There's no word on if the tainted batch reached other shores.



Escape

THORN IN HIS EYE

Ballmer Goes Ballistic!

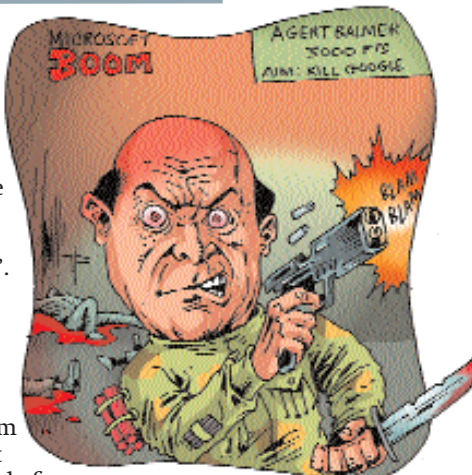
If recent reports (or rumours, if you like) are to be believed, Steve Ballmer, CEO of Microsoft, has a mid-year resolution: To Kill Google! And he made his intentions clear in no uncertain terms.

Mark Lucovsky, an engineer who had been with MS for six years, announced he was leaving to take up a job at Google. This isn't the first time something of the sort has happened—Google has also been responsible for poaching Microsoft executive Kai-Fu Lee to oversee an R&D centre that Google plans to open in China.

As soon as Ballmer heard of Lucovsky's decision—and especially about where he was headed—Ballmer picked up his chair and hurled it across his office, according to the declaration filed in a Washington court. (There are sworn testimonies from Lucovsky about what Ballmer said.)

This, as Kai-Fu Lee recalls, was similar to his encounter with Ballmer in July when "Steve Ballmer swore like a trooper, and threw a chair around the office". The reports say Ballmer laced his ramblings with generous dosages of expletives and went on to say, "I'm going to bury that guy, I have done it before, and I will do it again..." referring to Google CEO Eric Schmidt.

But Ballmer, according to *The Wall Street Journal*, described Lucovsky's witness statement as an exaggeration and inaccurate. In a statement, Ballmer described Lucovsky's recollection as a "gross exaggeration. Mark's decision to leave was disappointing and I urged



him strongly to change his mind. But his characterisation of that meeting is not accurate."

Microsoft alleges that Lee breached his conditions of employment by taking a job with Google, and is now suing to prevent Lee from leading Google's China expansion, saying that doing that would violate the terms of a non-compete agreement that he signed.

UNUSABLE!

Steam from Valve

Anyone who has played *Half-Life 2* game has given it nothing but accolades. However, before they actually started playing the game, they fumed over its authentication system, aptly titled Steam.

Steam is proprietary software developed by Valve Corporation and consists of a Content Delivery System, Digital Rights Management and Multiplayer System all rolled into one. So far, so good! The problems start after you install *Half-Life 2* (the retail version). Before the game starts, you need to connect to the Steam server to authenticate your copy. Here's where the boat starts rocking. To connect to the Steam server, you need to wait at least half your lifetime. And when you finally do, the software starts updating. Even if you reach 99 per cent, and the connection breaks, voila, you need to start from scratch.

If you don't want to go through this pain, then download the complete Steam software from the Valve Web site. Although, after you install this software, it still wants to connect to the Steam server. The wait period for connecting varies, but God save you if you are on dial-up.

While Valve's idea of delivering content is bright, its implementation isn't. And before we go, we will let you on to a secret. We didn't provide the *Half-life 2* demo on our DVD for the same reason!

Win! My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? E-mail with subject 'My Desktop' and your postal address to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

This month's winner receives
EA Cricket 2004 Game



The winner of this month is Karan Kadam
email: karankadam@gmail.com